

Idol Robbery - Ryan Ly

Quest Synopsis:

Find the Sacred Idol

During Act 1, following the completion of the [Steal the Sacred Idol](#) sub-quest, the players can speak to [Rath](#) and obtain a quest to find an alternative sacred idol for the druid's worship of Silvanus. This would lead the players to a dungeon where they can reclaim a lost **Idol of Silvanus** from the clutches of various goblins worshipping the absolute. This would create an interesting situation in which we could explore the concept of religious strife between two different beliefs.

Dungeon Name and Brief Lore:

[Ransacked Church of Silvanus](#)

The general concept is an abandoned underground church which would now be overrun by goblins. The church has also long been abandoned by the druids, so it's overrun by vines and ivy.

When it comes to location we need to consider a few things. First, the church would ideally be in a fairly secluded area, primarily surrounded by trees and wilderness. Unfortunately, there aren't a ton of isolated areas in Act 1, but we can still find a few good areas. There's an area north-east of the [Blighted Village](#). It's a stretch of wilderness with not much around it other than tall trees. Otherwise it could work by placing it on the far south of the map east of the swamp area. This area works exceptionally well because the players will need to go there at some point to [investigate Kagha](#).



When it comes to key items, notably there's only the 2nd Idol of Silvanus the player will find deep within the Ransacked Church of Silvanus. That said, I'd also like to open the alternative solution for the player to steal the original idol from [Mol](#), reclaiming the idol for the druids.

Level Structure:

The dungeon is primarily composed of 3 areas, excluding the entrance. First, the players would enter the temple and descend a staircase. There the players would find a corridor leading into the main area, the combat zone. This would be a large area where the goblins are living/drinking/sleeping. This main area would also house a set of stairs in the corner leading to a balcony area overlooking the room. There are also vines the players or goblins could climb to get up the balcony faster.

Moving on from the combat zone, the players will find a door that leads to the puzzle area. This puzzle zone would consist of riddles and various doorways that lead to the treasure room housing the Idol of Silvanus. I wanted to make the puzzle area not too annoying, so I focused on making it more fun and immersive. I'll elaborate more in the puzzle section. In total, this dungeon would grant the players 85 xp.

Combat Description:

The combat area has five goblins of various types and tiers, along with one worg. I wanted to make this a fairly easy fight, but it should still prove challenging for



newcomers. Notably, there's an archer goblin on the balcony and an elite melee goblin standing atop a pedestal. Other than that, the rest are generic melee goblins and one wizard goblin.

There are a few simple mechanics I incorporated into this level. First I introduced the balcony, which guides the player to take advantage of the higher ground. Additionally I decided to make all the goblins drunk and

place a few barrels of wine in one area of the combat zone. By setting the path for most of the goblins to walk near the barrels of wine, I created a 'heated' area where most of the goblins would occasionally walk near, allowing the players to take advantage of various AOE attacks. I had also placed 2 barrels of smokepowder in various locations in the combat zone, including one on the balcony.

Generally the idea was to guide the player, keeping in mind that they're likely new, of various ideal scenarios to promote strategic thinking. My main goal was to avoid the player from just running in and attacking.

Puzzle Description:

The puzzle room consists of a set of riddles that the player must answer by walking through one of three doors. The riddles would be fairly easy and themed around Silvanus/Druids. If the player answers correctly, they'd be put into the next room with a new riddle. If the player answers incorrectly, they'll be teleported back to the start of the puzzle area. I had envisioned the puzzle room as a sort of initiation room for new worshipers of



Silvanus, where they had to answer relatively easy riddles. Originally I also wanted to make the doors lock-pickable, so that the players could possibly bypass the puzzle, but I had trouble getting it working with the teleporting in mind.

Environment and Atmosphere References:

I really wanted to make this church look long abandoned and ransacked by the goblins. I started with the clean version of the church and then I tried to imagine how it'd look if it was overrun and covered in vines. I placed broken objects across the map and placed roots and ivy on various walls. I also wanted to make the balcony area look especially dilapidated, since the player would be looking at it for most of their time in the combat zone. Additionally, I placed a toppled statue of silvanus on the floor with a goblin now standing where the statue once was. There are also now banners for the absolute on the walls of the church to enforce the goblins original motive.

Things I couldn't implement:

There are a few things I wish I could've implemented. Like I mentioned previously, I wanted to make the puzzle room bypassable, but I struggled with the teleport system working well with the lockpicking. I was also thinking of implementing a new puzzle room altogether, one where the player would need to find the correct path across a few pressure plates, but I struggled with getting the player to teleport to the start if they stepped on the wrong pressure plate. Lastly, I wanted to include sleeping goblins in the combat zone, but I couldn't get them to actually wake up once the fight started.